It's not just about bricks and mortar; it's about a mindset shift. Take West Champaran, where Nitish unveiled 400 projects worth ₹752 crore—including a new sugar mill revival, tapping into the district's agrarian roots. Or Saran, which was gifted 52 schemes costing ₹985 crore, such as a trauma centre to cut mortality rates on NH-19. Darbhanga, a cultural hub famed for Mithila art, bagged 180 projects worth ₹2,000 crore, including a ring road to ease its perennial traffic snarls. Every district got its share, a district-wise blueprint ensuring no corner is left behind. This isn't top-down diktat—it's development with a local pulse, tailored to each region's needs, informed by grassroots feedback the CM has honed over his numerous tours.

Nitish Kumar's tenure since 2005 has been punctuated by bold moves. Law and order was his first triumph—once a land where daylight robberies, murders and kidnappings were rampant, Bihar saw crime rates plummet as police stations were revitalised. A 2019 NCRB report pegged Bihar's crime rate at 185 per lakh, below the national average of 241. Roads followed, weaving a network that shrank distances and spurred trade—by 2020, the state boasted over 100,000 km of rural roads, up from 30,000 km in 2005. Education got a shot in the arm—girls' enrolment soared thanks to schemes like the Mukhyamantri Cycle Yojana, which handed out free cycles to 1.4 million schoolgirls by 2015, slashing dropout rates.

Then came electricity—a luxury in 2005, a norm by 2025. Power generation leapt from 700 MW to over 6,000 MW, as per the Bihar State Power Holding Company, lighting up 98% of households by 2023. Healthcare improved with new hospitals and free medicines—AIIMS Patna, opened in 2012, stands as a testament. Millions of government jobs—over 6 lakh since 2005,



including 2.5 lakh teachers in 2023 alone—lifted families out of poverty. The 2016 liquor ban was a gutsy call to curb domestic violence and addiction, backed by a 2021 study showing a 15% dip in related crimes. The Jal Jeevan Hariyali campaign, launched in 2019, married sustainable development with environmental care, planting 25 crore trees and reviving 20,000 water bodies by 2024. These aren't just policies; they're lifelines for a state clawing its way up.

A TRAVELLER OF TRANSFORMATION

The Chief Minister is no stranger to the road. The Pragati Yatra was his 15th statewide tour, a testament to his hands-on style. From the Nyay Yatra of 2005, tackling justice delays, to the Vikas Yatra of earlier years, he's crisscrossed Bihar, listening to grievances and sketching solutions. This latest journey, spanning 60 days, is his most ambitious yet. Covering 38 districts, he didn't just wave from a podium—he plunged into the nitty-gritty, announcing projects that promise to redefine Bihar's skyline. His Janata Darbars—public grievance forums— complement these tours, resolving over 1 lakh complaints annually, ensuring his ear stays close to the ground.

The scale is unprecedented. Never before has a single tour yielded such a deluge of schemes. With ₹50,000 crore committed and cabinet approvals secured by February, the pace is breakneck. North Bihar's package targets its flood-prone plains such as Kosi embankments in Supaul, while South Bihar's focuses on its rugged terrain, like Rohtas' industrial zones. It's a dual-pronged assault on underdevelopment, executed with surgical precision, backed by a bureaucracy, which is now responsive and accountable.

Modern highways, overbridges, elevated corridors, and ring roads are set to decongest cities and link villages in the state. Patna's JP Ganga Path will stretch from Didarganj to Mokama, slashing travel times by 40%. Nehru Path's drainage will be paved over for a sleek road to Saguna More. Gola Road, Rajiv Nagar, and Anandpuri will see widened streets, banishing bottlenecks that once choked Patna's western flank.

Beyond the capital, Nalanda's Hilsa gets an eastern bypass, Bihar Sharif's Ranchi Road broadens, and

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Nitish Kumar's Pragati Yatra has lit a new spark, turning hope into momentum. As the edifying vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047 beckons, Bihar is all geared up to contribute to its realisation as a prominent player in India's development story.